

JACK SENECHAL

TECHNOLOGY EXECUTIVE · ENGINEERING & PLATFORM LEADERSHIP

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SUMMARY

Technology leader with **6+ years leading engineering and platform organizations** whose platform every engineering team and the entire customer-facing product depended on. Sets standards and governance, rebuilds teams that are struggling, modernizes legacy systems without disrupting the people who rely on them, and develops the next layer of leaders.

- **Enterprise platform leadership:** owned the shared infrastructure platform for an entire engineering organization, balancing central standards against the autonomy individual teams needed to keep moving.
- **Governance and standards:** established the policies, review gates, and operating practices that changed how an organization built and shipped, then carried them across teams as a change agent rather than by mandate.
- **Turnarounds:** rebuilt a critical operations team from two engineers after mass departures, and took an unreliable production platform to **~100x fewer errors and incidents**.
- **Legacy modernization:** led migrations of long-lived systems onto modern cloud platforms, including a **zero-downtime** cutover with no customer-visible impact.
- **Developing leaders:** grew multiple junior engineers into senior software engineer and engineering manager roles, and mentored engineers across teams. **Top Performer Award, 2021**.
- **Responsible AI adoption:** builds and operates AI-assisted delivery systems with the governance attached, review, testing, and supply-chain controls enforced by the system rather than left to good intentions. Co-founded a nonprofit that publishes an open-source benchmark for humane AI behavior.
- **Translating technology for decision-makers:** the working habit of most of this career has been explaining technical tradeoffs, risk, and cost to people who do not want a technical answer, they want a decision.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Consultant · AI-Native Software Delivery

Client engagements | May 2026 - Present | Remote

Scope: designs the delivery process and governance model; holds the product and prioritization seat.

- Designs and runs **AI-assisted delivery pipelines** that carry engineering work from requirement to production, with a human accountable for scope, priority, and acceptance.
- **Governance built into the system:** every change passes an independent reviewer, automated testing, supply-chain security scanning, and a deployment verification step. The operating thesis, proven in practice, is that anything merely instructed rather than enforced will drift.
- Uses a single durable system of record for work intake, review, and status, with status **derived from verifiable reality** rather than maintained by hand in a tracker nobody trusts.
- Practical view of where AI adoption pays off and where it does not, grounded in running it daily rather than in vendor claims.

Co-founder & Fractional CTO

Building Humane Technology | June 2025 - Present | Remote (part-time)

Scope: technical direction and roadmap for a nonprofit engineering team; advises rather than implements.

- **Originated and co-architected HumaneBench.ai**, an open-source framework for evaluating whether AI systems behave in the public interest, covering transparency, privacy, and user wellbeing.
- Serves as **fractional CTO** to the team that built it into a published, externally used product, shaping architecture, evaluation design, and technical direction.
- Designed and specified a **real-time evaluation classifier** that scores AI behavior against those standards inline at **sub-100ms**, fast enough to sit in a live request path rather than run only after the fact.

- Owns technical product direction: operational visibility, evaluation feedback loops, and adoption maturity models organizations can actually follow.

Co-founder & Software Engineer

Alchemy Astrology (formerly Mirror Astrology) | Nov 2024 - Jul 2026 | Remote

Scope: co-founder; owned front-end and design delivery, including outside design contractors.

- Owned front-end and design delivery for a production consumer subscription service, and managed freelance designers through to shipped work.
- Collaborated on back-end delivery: payment processing, single sign-on authentication, and application architecture.
- Partnered with co-founders on product direction, roadmap, and prioritization.

Infrastructure Engineer

Tobiko | Mar 2024 - Oct 2024 | Remote

Scope: cloud platform serving production customer workloads.

- Architected and operated a cloud platform running production customer workloads, with reliability, security, and repeatability as the standard.
- Implemented infrastructure as code so environments were provisioned from reviewed, version-controlled definitions instead of by hand.
- Stood up a customer support and incident response workflow, and onboarded staff and customers onto it.

Engineering Manager / Principal Software Engineer

Mavenlink / Kantata | Apr 2017 - Dec 2023 | San Francisco, CA

Scope: led two engineering teams over seven years, including the shared infrastructure platform relied on by every engineering team in the company. Partnered with product, security, and application groups on standards adopted organization-wide.

- **Infrastructure Platform and DevOps** (4 years): Took over a team reduced to two engineers by mass departures and rebuilt it: recruiting, onboarding, documented practice, and an on-call rotation the team could sustain. Led the organization's engineering-practice transformation as a change agent and technical authority across the company, setting standards other teams adopted because they worked, not because they were mandated. Owned roadmap, intake and triage of requests from every engineering team, and priority tradeoffs among them.
- **Legacy modernization:** Moved a long-lived codebase and its server estate onto modern cloud-native, infrastructure-as-code tooling, replacing hand-built systems with reproducible, auditable configuration. Led the migration of the core application and its surrounding services onto a modern container platform, and moved an unstable production database onto a managed service, eliminating an entire class of outages. Migration decisions were made on scale, cost, and consistency grounds.
- **Integrations platform turnaround** (2 years): Led the team that stabilized and scaled the platform connecting the company's product to customers' external systems. Established the operational metrics, monitoring, and alerting that took it from frequent customer-visible failures to **~100x fewer errors and incidents**, then executed a **zero-downtime migration** onto the modern platform with no customer impact.
- **Reliability and sustainable operations:** Drove a sustained push that dramatically reduced after-hours incident volume, which in turn produced strong retention and good working relationships across the engineering organization.
- **Analytics data pipeline** (3 months): Led a transition team that took ownership of a neglected analytics pipeline and modernized it.
- **Developing people:** Grew multiple junior engineers into senior software engineer and engineering manager roles, and mentored engineers across teams. Led interviewing and hiring. **Top Performer Award, 2021.**

Lead Developer, Co-founder

Pegg | 2014 - 2017 | San Francisco, CA

- Co-founded and led development of a cross-platform mobile product from scratch.
- Established the engineering workflow the team ran on: peer review, automated testing, and continuous delivery.
- Co-led product strategy, monetization, and launch planning.

Earlier Career (2001 - 2014)

- **Consultant & Entrepreneur** (2008 - 2014): Founded an automated-testing education venture. Delivered custom systems for commercial clients, including an e-commerce ordering platform for an established retailer. Full-stack consulting and rapid delivery.
- **Web Developer, OnForce, Inc** (2006 - 2007): Introduced automated testing and continuous integration. Integrated the platform with third-party enterprise systems.

- **Development Lead, JBA Network** (2003 - 2006): Lead programmer and project manager for a commercial software product. Architected the initial release, then built and scaled the development team.

LEADERSHIP PRACTICE

- **Governance and standards:** policy, review gates, change control, and documented practice, set centrally and adopted willingly because they reduce work rather than add it.
- **Modernization:** legacy system replacement, cloud migration, data platform migration, phased cutover planning, zero-downtime delivery.
- **Operations:** monitoring and alerting, incident response and postmortems, on-call design, disaster recovery, security posture and access management.
- **Vendor and cost discipline:** platform and vendor selection on cost, risk, and long-term maintainability; consolidation onto managed services where it lowers total cost of ownership.
- **People:** hiring and team building, coaching, succession through growing individual contributors into senior and management roles, cross-functional partnership, change management.
- **Communication:** translating technical risk and tradeoffs into terms non-technical stakeholders can decide on.
- **Technical depth:** cloud platforms (AWS, Google Cloud), Kubernetes and containers, infrastructure as code (Terraform, Ansible), CI/CD, relational and document databases, API and systems architecture, AI and LLM systems.

EDUCATION

BA in Mathematics, minor in Computer Science

University of North Carolina at Asheville | May 2003

- Graduated with distinction in Mathematics.

SELECTED OPEN SOURCE

- **HumaneBench:** open-source framework for evaluating human-friendly behavior in AI assistants, covering transparency, privacy, and wellbeing.
- **Scan MCP:** privacy-first document digitization tooling.

RECOMMENDATIONS

“Jack has **had quite a profound impact on my career**. As a young engineer, I was fortunate enough to work with Jack as my coach. He served as a great mentor, helping me build both technical and professional skills. **His mentorship was a key factor in elevating me from an incoming Junior Engineer to an Engineering Manager.**”

— Wesley Morlock, *Engineering Manager, Kantata*

“Jack is **an exceptional engineer and leader**. He strives to **deeply understand the technology** he’s working on while remaining cognizant of the socio-technical components that may be a factor in any project. He does all this with a **strong team mentality**, and can **effectively delegate to help lift others’ skill sets.**”

— Brandon Clifford, *Director of DevOps, Kantata*

See additional recommendations on LinkedIn

The latest version of this document can be found at <http://jacksenechal.com/resume>